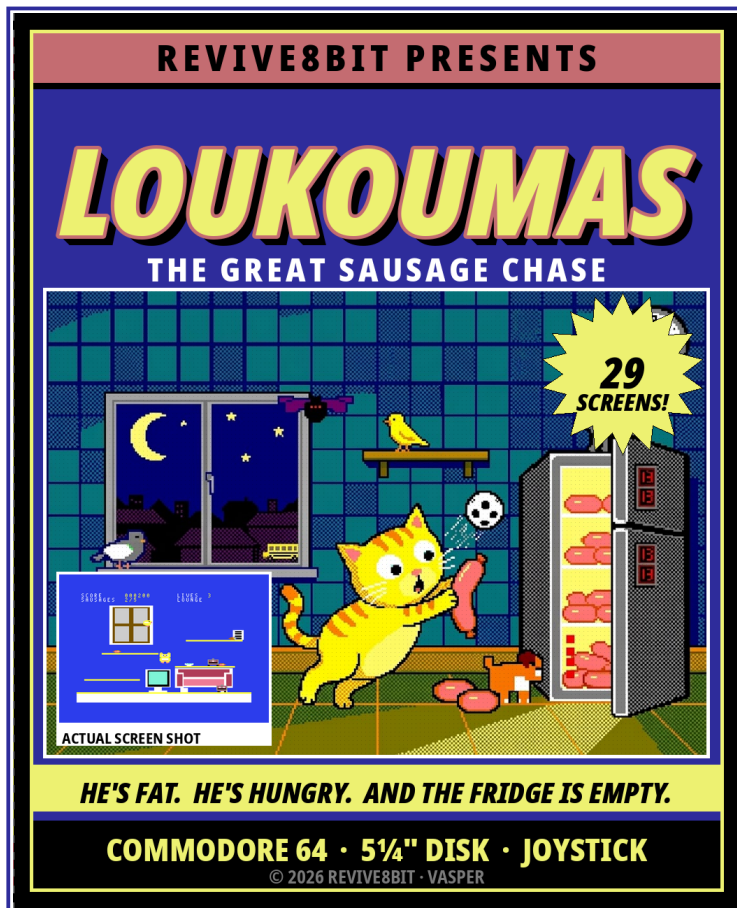


LOUKOUMAS

THE GREAT SAUSAGE CHASE

COMMODORE 64 · 5¼" DISK · JOYSTICK OR KEYBOARD

A REVIVE8BIT production · © 2026



The disc inlay — the front of it.

Ελληνικά: MANUAL.el.md · Booklet: English PDF, Greek PDF

LOADING

1. Switch on the disk drive, then the Commodore 64.
2. Put the disk in the drive, label side up, and close the latch.
3. Type

```
LOAD "*",8
```

and press **RETURN**. When it says **READY.**, type

```
RUN
```

and press **RETURN** again.

4. The screen goes black for a few seconds, then the REVIVE8BIT screen comes up while the game loads.
5. About twenty seconds later the title screen appears and the music starts.

It loads through its own fast loader on a **1541** or **1541-II**. Any other drive — an SD2IEC, a 1571 — still loads it, at the ordinary speed: count on a minute and a half.

Do not switch anything off or open the drive while its light is on.

Any C64 or C64C, PAL or NTSC. Plug the joystick into port 2 — or leave it out and use the keyboard.



The title screen. FIRE goes on, L switches to Greek.

THE STORY SO FAR

It is a quarter past three in the morning in Mrs Evdokia's flat in Kypseli. Everybody is asleep. Everybody except one.

Loukoumas — a plump, overweight European Shorthair with short legs, enormous eyes and an unappeasable love of cured meats — has been woken by a rumble in his own stomach. Mrs Evdokia has put him on a diet, and the house is no longer his: a robot vacuum patrols the floors all night, and her canary, the **Tweety-Boxer**, has the run of every room.

Loukoumas starts in the basement with one intention: to climb all the way up to the kitchen and open the big two-door Pitsos.

And he finds it empty.

The last one, the big one, went to school in the lunchbox of **Myrto**, Mrs Evdokia's granddaughter. Outside, the school bus is starting its engine.

From there it stops being a raid and becomes a chase, and it lasts another nineteen rooms: out through the back yard, across the neighbourhood, through the whole school, into the

vet's — and home over the rooftops and down the chimney into his own fireplace, where Myrto has left him a bowl of milk.



Act two: out of the flat and into the back yard, in daylight.



Act three: home over the rooftops, and down the chimney.

Twenty-nine rooms. Nine lives — or three, if you ask for them. One sausage.

THE CONTROLS

Joystick in port 2 or the keyboard — either, at any time.

Keyboard	Joystick	What it does
O P	left / right	Walk
Q or SPACE	up or fire	Jump
A	down	Roll — curl into a ball
A + SPACE in mid-air	down + fire	BELLY-FLOP
L (title screen only)	—	Switch between Greek and English
SPACE (title screen)	fire	Start
RUN/STOP	—	Abandon the game and go back to the title

Rolling is faster than walking *and* shorter than standing. There are gaps in this game that a standing cat does not fit through. There is no dignity in it. There is no dignity in any of this.

★ THE BELLY-FLOP ★

Jump, then hold down (**A**) and hit fire (**SPACE**) while you are still in the air. Loukoumas tucks in, drops like a sack of flour and lands flat on his stomach. **The whole room shakes** — and everything at roughly the height he landed at is stunned where it stands, however far along the shelf it happens to be.

This is not a trick. It is the answer to a robot that patrols a whole shelf and will not let you near the sausage on the end of it. Flop, then walk straight through it while it sees stars.

How to do it

- You have to be **in the air** — on the way up, at the top, or falling. Walking off the edge of a shelf counts as much as a jump does. On the ground, down is a roll and nothing else.

- Hold down first, then **press** fire. Holding fire down from the jump does nothing: it has to be a fresh press while down is held. Up will not do it — only fire.
- Once he has tucked in there is no taking it back. He drops at full speed, straight down, and still drifts left and right if you steer.

Where it reaches

- The stun goes off **on landing**, not when you press the button. Flop in mid-air over a robot and it is the shelf you come down on that counts.
- It reaches **sideways across the whole room**. Distance along the shelf does not matter at all.
- It reaches **up and down by about one shelf**: the shelf you landed on, the one just above it and the one just below. Anything two shelves away keeps coming.
- Things in the air are caught too, if they are inside that band at the moment you land. A canary on its way through stops dead in mid-flight.

What it does, and for how long

- A stunned enemy **stops where it is, blinks grey and cannot hurt you**. Walk through it, stand on its shelf, take the sausage behind it.
- It stays down for **two, three or four seconds**, depending on the difficulty (see *HOW HARD DO YOU WANT IT*). There is no warning when it gets up — it simply starts moving again, and from that moment it is dangerous.
- Flop again and the clock starts again, at full length, for everything in reach.
- **Loukoumas pays for it too**: for about a quarter of a second after landing he lies flat and does not answer the controls. Anything awake and out of reach — a bird two shelves up, say — can still catch him there.

A stunned enemy is harmless scenery — but only until it gets back up.

YOUR SCREEN

Two rows across the top, and they are the only part of the screen that is not the game:

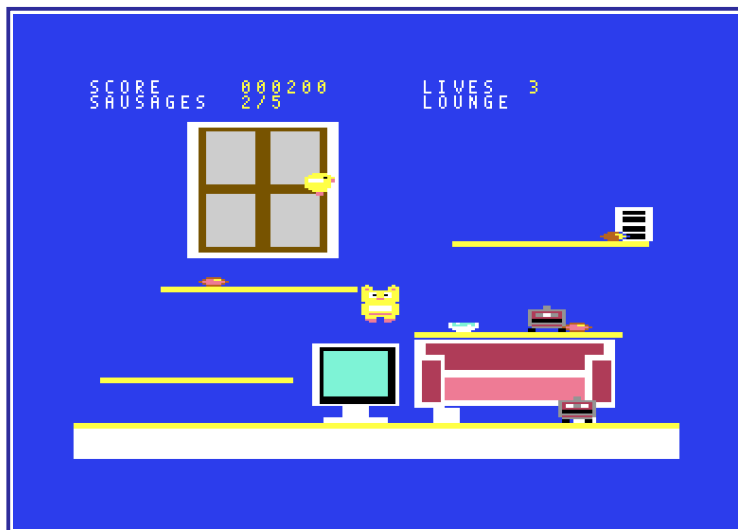
SCORE 000500

LIVES 3

SAUSAGES 5/5

KITCHEN

SCORE	Six digits. It does not reset between rooms
LIVES	Nine, six or three, depending on the difficulty you chose. That number is also the most you can hold
SAUSAGES	How many of this room's five you have found
Room name	Where you are. All twenty-nine have one



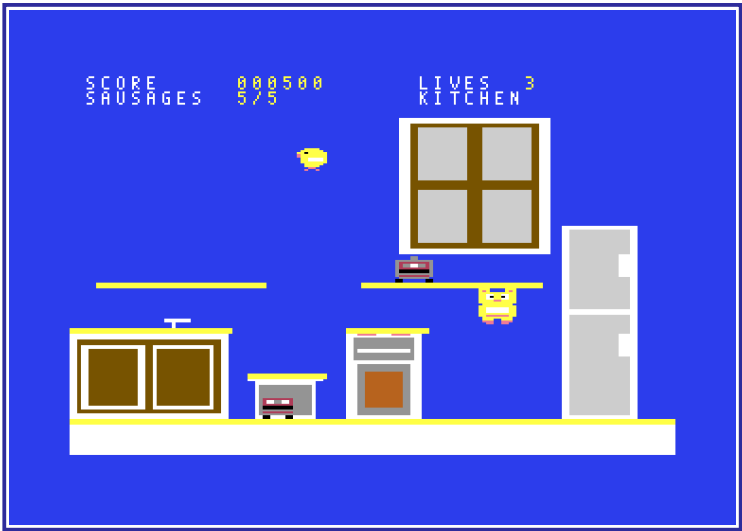
The lounge: the score on top, the canary on its rounds, a robot by the sofa.

When a saucer of milk gives you a life back, **the border flashes yellow**. It is the only thing on the screen that you cannot miss while you are being chased.

WHAT YOU ARE AFTER

SAUSAGES — five in every room, 100 points each. Take all five and the way out of the room — a door, a vent, a fridge, a chimney — **changes** and becomes a way through. Until then it is furniture. You do not have to find them in any order, and nothing comes back if you lose a life, so a room only ever gets easier.

THE SAUCER OF MILK — every third room. Rooms 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18, 21, 24 and 27 have one. It is always worth **500 points**, and if you have lost a life it gives one back as well — but never more than the number you started the game on. It is worth a great deal more once you have started losing them, and on hard, where you only ever had three, more still.



The kitchen with all five sausages taken — and the Pitsos empty.

It is always on the most awkward shelf in the room, and usually on the one something is patrolling. The way out does not wait for it: you can finish the room and leave it behind. Whether that is the right call is between you and your remaining lives.

WHAT IS AFTER YOU

Three in every room. Touching any of them costs a life and puts you back at the start of the room with **two seconds of grace** — the cat blinks while it lasts — to get out of the way.

Everything in this game either walks a shelf or flies an arc across the room. Learn the two and you have learned all twelve:

	Walks	Flies	Where
Robot vacuum	●		the flat

	Walks	Flies	Where
The canary		●	the flat
Next door's terrier	●		back yard, pavement, the vet's
Pigeon		●	park, street, rooftops
Wasp		●	anywhere with flowers
Football	●		playground, gym, pitch
Paper plane		●	the school
The caretaker's bucket	●		the school
Something green	●		the chemistry lab
Syringe		●	the vet's
Bat		●	rooftops, chimney
The stray tom	●		rooftops, car park

Nothing shoots at you. Nothing follows you. They do not have to — the rooms are small and you are not fast.

HOW HARD DO YOU WANT IT

After the title screen, and before the first room, the game asks. Use left and right (**O** and **P**) to change it and fire (**SPACE**) to accept.



It borrows the title screen's footer: the question, the answer, and the keys.

	Lives	Enemies	The belly-flop stun lasts
EASY	9	Half speed; things that fly, a third	Four seconds
MEDIUM	6	Two thirds; things that fly, half	Three seconds
HARD	3	Full speed	Two seconds

HARD is the game as it was designed — three lives, and everything moving at the speed it was drawn to move at. Easy and medium do not make Loukoumas faster or the rooms kinder: they give you more lives and longer to think. The jump is the same jump, the shelves are the same distance apart, and every sausage is in the same place.

SCORING

Sausage

100

Saucer of milk

500 — and a life back, if you have lost one

There is no time bonus and no end-of-room bonus. The score is what you picked up.

WHEN IT ENDS

Lose your last life and the room stops where it stands with **GAME OVER** across it. Press fire (**SPACE**) to start again from the first room at the same difficulty, or **RUN/STOP** to go back to the title screen — and to the language and difficulty menus with it.



Out of lives. FIRE starts a new game, RUN/STOP goes back to the title.

Get through all twenty-nine and you get **WELL DONE!**, which in 1986 was considered generous.

HINTS FROM THE PLAYTESTERS

- **Look before you jump.** The jump clears about twenty-nine lines and the shelves are twenty-four apart, so every shelf is reachable from the one below it — but only from

the one below it.

- **Platforms are one-way.** You land on a shelf falling, and you pass straight up through it rising. That is a route, not a bug: go up through the thing you cannot walk around.
- **The flop is a key, not a weapon.** Nothing in this game dies. A shelf you cannot cross is a shelf you have not flopped on yet.
- **Take the milk when you are down a life or two.** Untouched it is only points; one short, it is the way back up. It is on the hardest shelf in the room either way, and you will not want to go back for it on your last one.
- **Learn where the canary turns.** Everything that flies bounces between the same two walls for ever. Stand where it has just been.
- **Rolling under something is usually faster than jumping over it,** and it is always safer than landing on it.
- **RUN/STOP is not a pause.** There is no pause. It was 1986.

FOR THE TECHNICALLY MINDED

The rooms are a **multicolour bitmap**, 160 double-width pixels by 184 lines, with the score above them in ordinary text: the screen changes mode on one raster line at the top and back again in the border, every frame. A multicolour cell is four pixels by eight and can show only four colours, so every room is drawn box by box through an allocator that hands out each cell's colours as the room asks for them — and a checker that runs the same rules refuses to build the game if a single cell in any of the twenty-nine rooms comes out wrong.

The cat and the three enemies are **hardware sprites**, two to a picture, one laid over the other for a second colour: all eight of the machine's sprites, every frame. The game thinks and draws fifty times a second; on an NTSC machine it skips one step in six, so everything keeps its speed in seconds.

The disk loads through a **fast loader** of its own: a program put into the 1541's memory that finds the files itself and sends them two bits at a time, about ten times what the KERNAL manages. The title music was written for the **SID**: all three of its voices, with a slide whistle, chords played as fast arpeggios, and a snare made of noise. In the game the sound effects have the chip to themselves.

Both languages are in the same program, and **L** repaints the lettering rather than the screen.

How the machine is driven is in CLAUDE.md; the plan the port followed is loukc64.md.

CREDITS

Code, graphics and design

VASPER

Music

Written for the SID

Published by

REVIVE8BIT, 2026

Loukoumas is a cat. No sausages were harmed in the making of this game. The same cannot be said for the diet.